

Visiting Vietnam

War tourism is a growing industry in Vietnam and attracts many veterans—especially American veterans. Today, visitors can tour museums, prison camps, and tunnels, or visit monuments and cemeteries, to learn more about the war or pay respects to the fallen.

BA RIA-VUNG TAU

Con Son Island

This island was first used as a penal colony during the French colonial period. The island's prisons remained in use until the fall of Saigon in 1975. In 1970, the prisons were visited by US Congressional representatives who notably reported seeing prisoners kept inside "tiger cages" –small concrete pits covered by bars. Today, Hang Duong Cemetery on Con Son is a site of pilgrimage, housing the remains of the 22,000 prisoners who died on the island.

BINH DUONG

Binh An Cemetery

This cemetery—previously known as the Bien Hoa Military Cemetery—was established in 1965 for soldiers of the South Vietnamese Army (ARVN), but does not appear to have been used until 1968. The cemetery's location on Highway 1 is marked with a sculpture, nicknamed "Thuong Tiec," of a tired ARVN soldier.

BINH PHUOC

Phuoc Long Victory Monument

The Battle of Phuoc Long, which began in December 1974, was a key defeat for the ARVN and an important precursor to the final North Vietnamese (NVA) offensive. The monument bears the date, January 6, 1975, when the NVA victory was sealed and the province was "liberated."

BINH THUAN

Ho Chi Minh Museum, Phan Thiet

Set on the banks of the Ca Ty River, this small museum contains artifacts and photographs from the life of communist leader Ho Chi Minh.

DA NANG

Zone 5 Military Museum

This museum in Da Nang's Hai Chau District has both indoor and outdoor displays of objects, weapons, aircraft, and vehicles that were used in Tactical Zone 5 during the war.

Ho Chi Minh Museum

Next door to the Zone 5 Museum, this museum contains three galleries of photographs and documents pertaining to the leader, as well as a reconstruction of his home in Hanoi.